

phone charging system can charge about 1.2 million phones for people living off the grid.

Then there is a new micro-grid model that promises to deliver solar power to every village in India very soon. Brian Shaad, co-founder of Mera Gao Power, a micro-grid firm, elaborated in one of his meetings with *Economics Times*, "A customer would spend ₹ 160 a month for his mobile charging and kerosene for lamps. We charge him ₹ 100." He further said that, the model has grown fast and has been gaining 2000 subscribers per month.

There seems to be a lot of competition in the solar market currently, and the Delhi Metro Corporation (DMRC) does not want to be left out of it. They have recently inaugurated their first 500kWp roof-top solar power plant at Dwarka, sector 21. The Airports Authority of India (AAI) has signed an agreement with the Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) for installation of solar plants of 50MW cumulative capacity in phase one of its new initiative. This is supposed to increase to 150MW later.

Gujarat has a 'rent-a-roof' project where the locals rent their rooftops to the solar companies, which in turn pay them a sum of ₹ 3 for every unit of energy produced. Delhi government sent its team of experts and top officials to Gujarat to study it and now is all set to deploy this system in government schools and hospitals.

Even DLF is all set to install solar panels on the top of its official buildings in cities like Chennai, Gurgaon, Delhi and Kolkata. To start with, it has decided to install solar panels on the roof-tops of its commercial buildings. Companies like Aniron Solarcity (UK based) and Azure Power India have partnered up with DLF for this project to produce about 3MW of power. They will link this generated power to the main power supply to provide an uninterrupted power supply.

Government policies and initiatives

As per *efytimes.com*, Piyush Goyal, the Union Energy Minister, met with



Fig. 4: Kochi power project

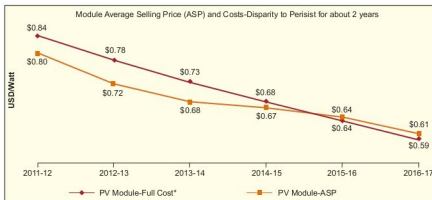


Fig. 5: Forecast of solar PV module costs

NHPC had contacted us for offering technical know-how and installation assistance for their proposed 50MW plant” — S.P. Gon Choudhury, Renewable Energy College

officers from relevant departments recently, and asked them about the progress made on ongoing solar power projects. He also guided them for achieving greater targets in the following stage of the country's solar power mission. The ministry is planning to revamp the social system of the Jawaharlar Nehru National Solar Mission in order to auction 770MW of utility scale solar PV in financial year 2014-15, under the gap funding scheme. The Centre for Wind Energy Technology (C-WET), an independent research and development institution and a section of MNRE, has ratified an agreement with the ministry to act together and distribute critical information to match the objects related to the solar energy.

ETDC, Bengaluru, a branch of STQC, has been approved for certifi-

ing solar inverters, street lights, home lights and lanterns. It also hints at possible amendment of the Electricity Act 2003 to encourage greater utilisation of renewable energy. This is also being supported by different cities. MNRE aims at developing 60 solar cities in India where solar energy would be used for garden lights, restaurants, hotels, street lights and administrative offices. Kochi already has a solar power plant under this scheme through which it is being turned into a solar city.

Through all this effort, the government wants to club all the solar and the conventional power sources and make renewable energy affordable to its people. Government also wants to tackle the delay in larger projects by eliminating roadblocks in the ongoing capacity addition programme